

At the end of the First World War, the Methodist Conference for NSW agreed to found a hospital as a war memorial. On Anzac Day 1919, Ellen Jane Vickery offered Edina – including the main house, front lawn, top tennis court, glass house, stables and men's quarters – to the Methodist Church for use as a hospital, in memory of her late husband Ebenezer Vickery, Jr. The terms of her gift required the Methodists to purchase the adjoining 3 acres of land containing the houses Wytchazel, Banksia and Ellerslie, and six cottages.

The Church accepted the terms of the offer in June 1919. Ellerslie was converted for use as an isolation ward for 19 patients, and became the first part of the hospital to be opened, in February 1921. The formal handover of the title deeds took place at the official opening of the War Memorial Hospital by the Governor Sir W. Davidson on Remembrance Day, 1922. The hospital operated under the *Private Hospitals Act* 1908 and was overseen by a board which included representatives of the Vickery family.

Upon opening, the hospital contained 92 beds in Edina and Ellerslie. Banksia and Wytchazel provided accommodation for nurses. From its opening, the hospital was accredited as a training hospital for general nurses. Over the ensuing years, developments in medical practice saw the following changes and additions to the former Edina estate:

- 1923 New wing added to Edina for operating theatre
- 1933 Vickery Memorial Chapel was built with a bequest by the Vickery family as a memorial to Ellen Jane Vickery, who died in 1932.
- 1933 Coach house and stables converted to laundry.
- 1935 New hospital block, designed by Noel W. McPherson was opened by the NSW Premier. It functioned as a maternity block.
- 1952 Elizabeth Hunter Nurses Home was purpose-built for nurses' accommodation.
- 1963 Construction of Eastern Suburbs Senior Citizens Welfare Centre on Bronte Road.